

DIY - Geek Survival Kit

A simple list of things the average geek needs to get by when the going gets tough and there just isn't enough to do

Tips & tricks

Gmail, Skype, netCut / Netcut Defender, web apps, Unity, Google Analytics covered this month

Internet woes, power deficiency and one crazy laptop...

... things may not be the way they seem to be

Power plans on the laptop

My laptop is Dell Inspiron n-5110, 2nd gen Core i5, 1 GB NVIDIA GeForce 525m, 4 GB RAM and Windows 7 Home Basic. When I plug my laptop to the power supply, its performance in games is much better as compared to when it isn't charging. I want optimum performance even when my laptop isn't charging. Please tell me how.

Abhinav Sharma

 You can go to the Power Management settings in the Control Panel (**Control Panel > System and Security > Power Options**), and adjust your laptop's power management plans. Most



Modify power settings to suit your needs

laptops, when on battery, have a power-saving plan by default, which might result in poor gaming performance. You can either choose "High Performance", a pre-designed plan, or create your own power plan to suit your needs. You can select the various parameters to have a few features set to maximum performance and switch off/reduce other parameters which would be of little use during gaming. Wi-fi performance would be of little use if you are playing an offline game.

Graphics conundrum

Whenever I try to open my ATI CCC I'm not able to change my display setting at all. I

tried to search on the net but did not get any positive vibes from there. I tried to install latest drivers from HP and from ATI, but then also I'm not able to change it. Last, I tried to do system restore (Factory Restore) but then also I'm not able to change it. Can you please suggest how to change my display setting in ATI. But on Intel HD 3000, I am able to change my display setting but the option is missing from my ATI Graphics Card. My laptop is a HP Notebook DV6 6115TX. Please help me with this problem. Last but not the least when I try to change my Graphics mode from Dynamic to Fix in my Bios Setting which is F.1B (latest) provided by HP, my V-Sync is always turned down. Any application or any image I try to edit my image starts to get a tearing feeling. I am not able to play single games in fix mode, but on net I have heard that in fixed mode you will be able to play games fluently, but in my case I am able to play only in Dynamic mode fluently. And in my Screen Resolution Setting I am only able to get the option of Intel but the ATI option is missing which is available in Fixed Mode. All my friends are having this kind of problem. So in behalf of all of them I want your help in this matter.

Dipan Talukdar

 1] Most likely you have switchable graphics turned on, while on low load the laptop will manually switch to HD3000 to cut power usage and thus your Catalyst Control Panel doesn't show the required settings. Switch off Switchable Graphics and check again.

2] Do you need V-sync? Do you experience image tearing while playing games? Enabling V-sync will limit your frame rate to that of your monitor's refresh rate which is usually 60Hz, so your FPS(frames per second) will be set to 60. Otherwise, let V-sync be turned off and

manually adjust the refresh rate till you no longer experience tearing will help. Though this is much more fussy and will lead to more issues when set to non-standard values.

Internet required!

I am a new reader but very impressed with the value presented in the issue I have seen.

I am a Swiss (61 years old) living in an Ashram at 7,000 ft elevation near Uttarakashi in Uttarakhand.

I don't have a lot of equipment as my life is simple. We have no phone or direct internet access here.

I do email a couple of times a week when the purchaser goes into town and takes my USB drive to the nearest internet cafe to do a send/receive.

Recently a friend sent me a Kindle Fire because we often don't have electricity and this way I can view documents, video files etc at leisure. I resisted the urge to try to root the Kindle to enable apps from Android such as Sanskrit Dictionary and Jyotish etc. which are not available from Amazon App Store so I am running plain out of the box system version 6.3

The problem is that most of the apps I did load on my trip to town to register the device on the Amazon site all of a sudden refuse to open. The error message says that the app needs to connect to the net. There is no real reason it would need to except maybe to check for updates but I can't find any way to restore functioning. My brother in the USA did a search on the error message and there was discussion about it but no solution short of opening the app while on-line every couple of weeks.

I have no desire to make a full day trip to the town and the internet cafe doesn't offer wifi anyway. For that one has to go to one specific hotel. Any suggestions you may have are most welcome.

Steve Herzfeld